COMPANY POLICY HANDBOOK

Employee, Candidate, Travel, Expense, Workplace & Benefits Guide

ASTERION TECHNOLOGIES (FICTIONAL DEMO COMPANY)

Version 1.0 | Illustrative handbook for a Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) demo | Prepared: October 2026

IMPORTANT NOTICE

This document is a fictional, general-purpose sample created for software demonstration and testing. It is not the official policy of any real employer and is not legal, tax, immigration, or benefits advice. All numbers, eligibility rules, timelines, and approval paths are illustrative. Before using this with real employees or candidates, replace every sample rule with approved company policy and applicable local law. If a rule is missing or unclear, the assistant should say so and direct the person to HR, Finance, or the relevant policy owner rather than inventing an answer.

How to Use This Handbook

This handbook is deliberately written with clear headings and repeated topic terms so a RAG assistant can retrieve relevant passages when users ask common questions.

- Audience: job applicants, interview candidates, new hires, employees, managers, and people managers.
- Scope: recruiting, work arrangements, working hours, leave, travel, reimbursements, pay, benefits, conduct, wellbeing, IT, security, facilities, performance, grievances, and separation.
- Demo-company assumption: a fictional mid-sized technology services company operating primarily in India, with some remote and client-site work.
- Priority rule: applicable law and signed employment documents take precedence over this sample handbook. Approved company policy takes precedence over informal statements.
- RAG behavior: answer only from retrieved policy text; quote the relevant rule when helpful; distinguish a stated rule from an example; ask a clarifying question when location, employment type, or dates matter; escalate if no policy is found.

Contents

1. 1. Company Overview and Employment
2. 2. Recruitment and Interview Candidates
3. 3. Work Hours, Attendance and Work Arrangements
4. 4. Leave, Holidays and Time Off
5. 5. Business Travel and Transportation
6. 6. Expenses, Reimbursements and Procurement
7. 7. Compensation, Payroll and Taxes
8. 8. Benefits, Lifestyle and Wellbeing
9. 9. Workplace Conduct, Inclusion and Dress
10. 10. IT, Data Privacy and Information Security
11. 11. Office Facilities, Visitors and Safety
12. 12. Learning, Performance and Career Development
13. 13. Complaints, Grievances and Investigations
14. 14. Resignation, Notice Period and Exit
15. 15. Frequently Asked Questions for RAG Testing
16. 16. Policy Ownership and Change Log

1. Company Overview and Employment

1.1 About the company

Asterion Technologies is a fictional technology services organization that develops software, data platforms, analytics solutions, and AI-enabled business tools for clients. The sample workforce includes engineering, data, consulting, operations, sales, HR, Finance, and support teams.

1.2 Employment categories

- Permanent employee: employed directly under an employment agreement, subject to the terms of that agreement and applicable law.
- Fixed-term employee: employed for a specified period or project under a written contract.
- Intern or trainee: engaged for a defined learning or work period; stipend, duration, benefits, and conversion eligibility are stated in the offer or internship letter.
- Contractor or consultant: provides services under a separate contract and is not automatically eligible for employee benefits.

- Probationary employee: an employee whose initial period and confirmation process are described in the offer letter or applicable policy.

1.3 Official documents and policy priority

The offer letter, employment agreement, approved policy documents, and applicable law govern the employment relationship. This handbook is only a sample. Employees should ask HR for the latest approved policy when documents conflict.

1.4 Equal opportunity and reasonable accommodation

The demo company aims to provide a workplace free from unlawful discrimination, harassment, and retaliation. Employment decisions should be based on job-related criteria. Requests for disability-related, religious, health-related, or other legally protected accommodations should be shared confidentially with HR for an individualized review.

1.5 Personal information changes

Employees should update their address, emergency contact, bank details, tax declarations, and other required records through the approved HR process. Sensitive information should be submitted only through authorized secure channels.

2. Recruitment and Interview Candidates

2.1 Applying and interview process

A typical process may include application review, recruiter discussion, technical or role-specific assessment, interviews, reference or background checks where lawful, and a final decision. The number of rounds and timeline vary by role; recruiters should confirm role-specific details.

2.2 Candidate expenses

Candidate travel or other interview expenses are reimbursable only if the recruiter or hiring team has explicitly approved them in writing before the expense is incurred. Candidates should retain itemized receipts and submit claims using the instructions provided. Do not assume that meals, accommodation, local transport, or lost wages will be reimbursed.

2.3 Accessibility and rescheduling

Candidates who need an accommodation, accessible interview format, or schedule change should contact the recruiter as early as possible. Requests will be handled discreetly and assessed fairly.

2.4 Offers and joining

Only an authorized written offer confirms proposed employment terms. Verbal statements during interviews are not a substitute for the offer letter. Joining date, compensation, location, background checks, documents, and conditions should be confirmed by the recruiter or HR.

2.5 Candidate data

Candidate resumes, interview notes, assessment results, and contact details should be accessed only by people involved in the hiring process and handled according to applicable privacy and retention rules.

3. Work Hours, Attendance and Work Arrangements

3.1 Working schedule

For demonstration purposes, the standard schedule is Monday through Friday, 9:30 a.m. to 6:30 p.m. local time, including a reasonable meal break. Actual working hours, weekly offs, shift timing, and break requirements depend on the employment agreement, team, client, and applicable law.

3.2 Attendance and punctuality

Employees should record attendance using the designated system, attend scheduled meetings on time, and notify their manager promptly if delayed or absent. Corrections to attendance records should be requested through the approved process.

3.3 Hybrid and remote work

Remote or hybrid work is subject to role requirements, manager approval, client commitments, information-security rules, and any location restrictions. Employees must keep work information secure, maintain availability during agreed core hours, and use approved devices and systems. Working from another country or an unapproved location may create legal, tax, security, or client issues and requires advance written approval.

3.4 Overtime and additional hours

Employees should not work additional hours without following the applicable manager-approval and time-recording process. Eligibility for overtime pay, compensatory time off, or shift allowances depends on role, contract, policy, and applicable law; this sample does not establish a universal entitlement.

3.5 Availability and communication

Teams should agree on reasonable response expectations, meeting hours, handover practices, and escalation contacts. Employees are not expected to be continuously available outside agreed working hours except where a documented role requirement or approved on-call arrangement applies.

4. Leave, Holidays and Time Off

Leave entitlements vary by work location, employment category, tenure, and applicable law. The figures below are sample placeholders for RAG testing only, not actual entitlements.

Leave type	Illustrative sample rule	How to request
Annual / earned leave	Example only: 18 working days per year, accrued monthly; subject to local rules and carry-forward limits.	Submit through HR system and obtain manager approval before planned leave.
Casual / personal leave	Example only: 6 days per year; local policy may differ.	Request in advance where possible; notify manager for urgent needs.
Sick leave	Example only: 6 days per year; medical documentation may be requested where lawful and appropriate.	Inform manager as early as possible and follow the HR process.
Public holidays	Published holiday calendar applies to the employee's work location and assigned schedule.	Check the official calendar; client teams may have different schedules.
Parental / maternity / paternity leave	Eligibility, duration, pay, and documentation follow applicable law and approved policy.	Contact HR confidentially to understand entitlements and process.
Bereavement / compassionate leave	Eligibility and duration are defined by the approved local policy.	Inform manager or HR; sensitive details should be shared only as necessary.

Unpaid leave	May be considered after review; approval is not automatic.	Submit a written request and confirm pay/benefit implications with HR.

4.1 Leave approval and emergencies

Planned leave should be requested as early as practical and approved before booking non-refundable travel. For illness or emergencies, notify the manager as soon as reasonably possible and complete system entries when able.

4.2 Leave balance, carry-forward and encashment

The HR system is the source of record for leave balances. Carry-forward, lapse, encashment, and final-settlement treatment depend on the approved policy and applicable law. Employees should confirm their specific balance with HR.

4.3 Working while on leave

Employees should arrange handover for planned leave. Managers should avoid unnecessary contact during leave. Any formal on-call or emergency duty should be clearly agreed in advance and handled according to policy.

5. Business Travel and Transportation

5.1 When travel is permitted

Business travel should support a legitimate business purpose such as a client meeting, project delivery, approved training, conference, or internal event. Obtain written manager approval before booking. The approval should identify the business purpose, dates, destination, estimated cost, project or cost center, and any special needs.

5.2 Booking and travel class

Item	Illustrative guidance
Air travel	Book economy class by default and choose a reasonable fare that meets business needs. Exceptions require written approval under the real company policy.
Train / intercity bus	Choose a safe, practical class consistent with trip duration, local policy, and budget.
Hotel	Use a preferred or approved property where available. Select a safe, reasonably priced room near the work location.
Taxi / rideshare	Use approved providers or a safe, cost-effective option. Keep the receipt and record the business purpose.
Personal vehicle	Use only where permitted; obtain prior approval and claim mileage at the approved rate. Do not assume fuel, tolls, parking, and mileage can all be claimed for the same trip.
Local public transport	May be claimed for business journeys when reasonable and supported by receipts where available.

5.3 Changes, cancellations and upgrades

Employees should choose flexible fares only when justified by business needs or approved. Notify the manager and travel coordinator promptly about cancellations or itinerary changes. Refunds, credits, and unused tickets belong to the company when company-funded, unless the approved policy states otherwise. Personal upgrades are not reimbursable unless explicitly approved.

5.4 Meals and incidentals

Meals during approved travel may be reimbursed under actual-expense or per-diem rules established by the real policy. Alcohol, minibar, entertainment, personal shopping, guest expenses, and costs already paid by a client or event organizer are excluded unless an approved exception says otherwise. Avoid duplicate claims.

5.5 Travel safety and insurance

Employees should review destination safety, weather, transport options, required documents, and emergency contacts before departure. Use company-provided travel insurance where available and follow any security advisory. Report an incident, injury, lost passport, or travel disruption promptly to the manager and designated support contact.

5.6 International travel

International travel requires advance approval and confirmation of passport validity, visa/work authorization, travel insurance, tax or immigration requirements, and permitted handling of company data. Employees must not perform work in a country if doing so would violate immigration, client, security, or company requirements.

5.7 Travel with personal days or companions

Personal extensions, companion tickets, room upgrades, and other personal costs are not reimbursable unless a written policy exception applies. Any personal extension must not increase company cost without explicit approval.

6. Expenses, Reimbursements and Procurement

6.1 General reimbursement principles

- Expenses must be necessary, reasonable, business-related, within approved budgets, and allowed by policy.
- Obtain prior written approval for travel, unusual purchases, client entertainment, conference fees, and any expense above the applicable limit.
- Submit an itemized invoice or receipt, date, amount, currency, business purpose, attendees where relevant, and project/cost-center details.
- Submit claims through the designated expense system within the actual policy deadline. Sample deadline for testing: within 30 days of the expense.
- Do not split transactions to avoid approval limits or claim the same cost twice.
- Personal expenses, fines, penalties, commuting costs (unless an approved exception applies), and unsupported purchases are generally not reimbursable.

6.2 Sample expense categories

Category	Sample handling
Business meals	State the business purpose and attendees; follow actual per-person limits and alcohol rules.
Internet / phone	Reimbursable only if the role and approved policy permit it; submit the required bill and allocation.
Laptop / accessories	Use IT/procurement channels. Do not purchase equipment independently unless authorized.
Training / certification	Obtain manager approval before enrollment; reimbursement may depend on completion and budget.
Client entertainment	Requires prior approval and compliance with anti-bribery, client, and local rules.
Home-office items	Only items listed in the approved home-office policy and within its limits are eligible.
Relocation	Available only if included in the offer or separately approved in writing.
Candidate interview expenses	Only expenses explicitly approved by the recruiting

team in advance are eligible.

6.3 Expense submission and payment

17. Collect itemized receipts and note the business purpose.
18. Create an expense claim in the approved system and select the correct category and cost center.
19. Attach receipts and approvals; provide currency and exchange-rate details for foreign-currency purchases as required.
20. Submit the claim to the designated approver.
21. Finance reviews the claim and may request clarification or reject ineligible items.
22. Approved claims are paid according to the published reimbursement cycle; ask Finance for the current schedule.

6.4 Missing receipts and rejected claims

If a receipt is unavailable, explain why and provide alternative evidence only if the actual policy permits it. Never fabricate a receipt. For a rejected claim, review the reason, correct missing information, and resubmit or appeal through Finance within the permitted period.

6.5 Purchasing and company assets

Employees must use approved vendors and purchase-order processes where required. Company assets must be used for authorized purposes, protected from loss, and returned when requested or at separation. Personal use, resale, or transfer of company equipment requires authorization.

7. Compensation, Payroll and Taxes

7.1 Salary and pay dates

Compensation is defined in the signed offer or employment agreement. The actual payroll calendar determines the pay date. The demo assumes monthly payroll, but no specific date or amount is guaranteed by this sample.

7.2 Payslips and deductions

Employees should review payslips for salary components, reimbursements, deductions, and tax withholding. Statutory contributions, professional tax, income-tax withholding, and other deductions depend on applicable law and individual circumstances. Contact Payroll or HR for corrections.

7.3 Bank details and payroll errors

Submit bank-detail changes only through the verified HR/payroll channel. Report a missing or incorrect salary payment promptly with the pay period and relevant details. Do not send bank credentials, passwords, or one-time passcodes to anyone.

7.4 Bonuses, incentives and salary reviews

Variable pay, bonuses, commissions, increments, and promotions depend on the applicable plan, eligibility, performance, business results, and written terms. They are not guaranteed unless the governing document explicitly says so.

7.5 Loans, advances and salary certificates

Salary advances, employee loans, employment letters, and salary certificates are subject to company process and applicable law. Submit requests to HR or Payroll; approval and turnaround time vary.

8. Benefits, Lifestyle and Wellbeing

8.1 Health insurance and medical support

Eligibility, coverage, dependents, exclusions, waiting periods, claim process, and insurer contacts are defined by the actual benefits plan. Employees should consult the plan document or benefits team before assuming a treatment, dependent, or expense is covered.

8.2 Wellness and mental wellbeing

The demo company encourages sustainable workloads, breaks, respectful communication, and use of available wellbeing resources. If an employee needs support, they may contact HR, a manager they trust, or an available employee-assistance provider. Confidentiality limits and emergency procedures should be explained by the actual provider.

8.3 Food, snacks and office amenities

Food subsidies, cafeteria access, snacks, beverages, gym access, recreational facilities, and similar lifestyle benefits vary by office and are not guaranteed unless listed in an approved benefits document. Employees should follow posted facility rules and leave shared areas clean.

8.4 Dress code and personal presentation

Employees should dress appropriately for their role, safety requirements, client meetings, and workplace context. The demo assumes smart casual attire is generally acceptable in the office, with role- or client-specific requirements where communicated. Dress standards should be applied consistently and accommodate legally protected needs.

8.5 Gifts, celebrations and social events

Participation in social activities is voluntary unless the event is a defined work requirement. Gifts, celebrations, and team events must remain respectful and comply with expense, anti-bribery, inclusion, and safety policies. Employees should not pressure colleagues to participate or contribute money.

8.6 Smoking, alcohol and substance use

Follow local law, designated-area rules, and safety requirements. Do not work while impaired or bring prohibited substances onto company premises or into work activities. Alcohol at an approved event, if permitted at all, must follow the real company's rules and never compromise safety or professional conduct.

8.7 Family, caregiving and work-life balance

Employees should discuss workload, schedule flexibility, and caregiving constraints with their manager or HR. Approval depends on role, team coverage, law, and company policy. Protected leave and accommodation requests should be handled under the applicable legal and HR process.

9. Workplace Conduct, Inclusion and Dress

9.1 Professional behavior

Employees should communicate respectfully, act honestly, protect confidential information, avoid conflicts of interest, and treat colleagues, clients, vendors, candidates, and visitors professionally.

9.2 Harassment, discrimination and retaliation

Harassment, bullying, unlawful discrimination, sexual harassment, threats, and retaliation for raising a good-faith concern are prohibited. Report concerns to HR, the designated ethics channel, or another authorized contact. Complaints should be handled promptly, fairly, discreetly, and in accordance with applicable law.

9.3 Conflicts of interest and outside work

Disclose actual or potential conflicts, including financial interests in vendors, close personal relationships affecting decisions, outside employment, or use of company information for personal gain. Obtain required written approval before taking outside work that could conflict with employment duties, client obligations, confidentiality, or working hours.

9.4 Gifts, anti-bribery and fraud

Never offer, request, or accept a bribe, kickback, improper payment, or gift intended to influence a business decision. Follow actual gift thresholds and declaration procedures. Report suspected fraud or misuse of funds through approved channels.

9.5 Social media and public statements

Employees may express personal views but must not disclose confidential information, misrepresent themselves as authorized company spokespeople, or post non-public client or employee data. Media requests should be referred to the authorized communications contact.

9.6 Political and personal activities

Personal political, civic, religious, and social activities must not be misrepresented as company positions. Use of company time, funds, premises, or branding for such activities requires authorization and must follow applicable law and company rules.

10. IT, Data Privacy and Information Security

10.1 Acceptable use

Company accounts, devices, networks, software, and AI tools should be used for authorized business purposes and limited reasonable personal use only if permitted by the actual policy. Employees must follow software licensing, access-control, and security requirements.

10.2 Passwords and multi-factor authentication

- Use unique passwords and approved multi-factor authentication.
- Never share passwords, recovery codes, or one-time passcodes.
- Use the approved password manager if one is provided.
- Lock screens when away and report suspected account compromise immediately.

10.3 Confidential information and data handling

Access only the data needed for your role. Classify, store, share, retain, and dispose of information according to its sensitivity and approved controls. Do not upload source code, customer data, employee records, credentials, contracts, or confidential company documents to public AI services or personal storage unless expressly authorized.

10.4 Generative AI use

Use only AI tools approved for the relevant data classification and task. Verify AI-generated output before relying on it; do not enter personal, confidential, regulated, or client data into an unapproved model. AI output must not be treated as authoritative policy unless checked against an approved source.

10.5 Phishing and security incidents

Do not open suspicious attachments, enter credentials from unexpected links, or bypass security controls. Report suspected phishing, lost devices, accidental data disclosure, malware, or unauthorized access immediately through the designated IT/security channel. Preserve evidence and do not attempt an unauthorized investigation.

10.6 Monitoring and privacy

Company systems may be monitored or logged to the extent permitted by law and disclosed in applicable notices. Access to employee information should be limited to legitimate business needs and handled under privacy requirements. Employees should consult the official privacy notice for retention, access, correction, and complaint procedures.

10.7 Intellectual property

Work product created within the scope of employment or using company resources may be subject to contractual intellectual-property terms and applicable law. Do not copy third-party code, content, datasets, or designs without the required license and approval. Report suspected infringement or accidental disclosure.

11. Office Facilities, Visitors and Safety

11.1 Access cards and visitors

Wear or carry the required access credential, do not lend it to others, and do not allow unauthorized tailgating. Visitors should be registered, escorted where required, and restricted to approved areas.

11.2 Workplace safety and emergencies

Follow fire, evacuation, ergonomic, laboratory, electrical, and other site-specific safety instructions. Know the nearest exit and assembly point. Report hazards, injuries, threats, and near misses promptly. In an immediate emergency, contact local emergency services first, then notify the company contact when safe.

11.3 Lost property and parking

Report lost property to office administration or security. Parking, bicycle storage, and transport facilities are subject to site rules and availability; use of a facility does not guarantee a reserved space.

11.4 Accessibility and shared spaces

Keep exits, accessible routes, and shared work areas clear. Respect quiet rooms, meeting-room booking rules, kitchen hygiene, and colleagues' need for focus. Requests for accessibility support should be directed to Facilities or HR.

12. Learning, Performance and Career Development

12.1 Goal setting and reviews

Managers and employees should agree on role expectations, measurable goals, feedback cadence, and development priorities. Review cycles, rating scales, calibration, and promotion criteria are defined by the actual performance policy and may vary by role.

12.2 Training and certifications

Training budgets and paid learning time require approval under the actual policy. Employees should confirm eligibility, approved providers, exam fees, repayment clauses if any, and proof-of-completion requirements before registering.

12.3 Internal mobility and promotion

Open roles, minimum tenure, manager notification, interview process, and promotion criteria depend on the internal mobility policy. Employees should use the official internal careers channel and discuss development goals with their manager.

12.4 Feedback and performance concerns

Employees may request feedback and clarification on expectations. If performance concerns arise, managers should communicate specific examples, expected improvements, support available, and review timelines in accordance with policy. Formal performance plans and consequences must follow the actual HR process.

13. Complaints, Grievances and Investigations

13.1 Raising a concern

Employees may raise concerns about safety, harassment, discrimination, ethics, payroll, policy interpretation, manager conduct, or other workplace matters with HR, their manager, an alternate manager, or an authorized ethics channel. Use an alternative contact if the usual contact is involved in the concern.

13.2 Handling and confidentiality

The company should acknowledge and assess reports, take proportionate steps, protect against retaliation, and share information only with those who need it to review the matter. Absolute confidentiality cannot be guaranteed where investigation, safety, or law requires disclosure.

13.3 Urgent risks

For immediate threats to life or safety, contact local emergency services and site security. Do not rely solely on a routine HR mailbox for emergencies.

13.4 Escalation and appeal

If the initial response does not resolve the concern, ask HR for the formal escalation or appeal route. Applicable statutory complaint mechanisms remain available as provided by law.

14. Resignation, Notice Period and Exit

14.1 Resignation

Employees who resign should submit written notice through the approved HR process and follow the notice period stated in their employment agreement, subject to applicable law and approved exceptions. The manager and HR should confirm the final working date in writing.

14.2 Notice period and early release

Notice duration, notice pay, leave adjustment, garden leave, and early release depend on the signed agreement and local law. Employees should not assume leave can automatically be used to offset notice.

14.3 Handover and return of assets

Before leaving, document work status, hand over responsibilities, return equipment and access cards, transfer approved files, and follow IT instructions. Do not retain confidential company or client information after authorization ends.

14.4 Final settlement and employment documents

Final salary, eligible leave encashment, reimbursements, statutory payments, deductions, tax documents, experience letters, and relieving letters are processed according to policy, contract, and law. HR/Payroll should provide the expected process and timeline; this sample does not guarantee a date.

14.5 Access after separation

Access to company systems is removed according to the offboarding schedule. Employees should not attempt to access systems after authorization ends. Questions about records or personal files should be directed to IT or HR before the final working day.

15. Frequently Asked Questions for RAG Testing

These short entries are examples of common questions. The assistant should use the corresponding detailed sections and should not treat illustrative numbers as real entitlements.

Q: Can I work from home every day?

A: Remote work depends on role, manager approval, client requirements, location restrictions, and the approved hybrid/remote policy. Ask your manager or HR for your team's current arrangement. See Section 3.3.

Q: What are the company's working hours?

A: The sample schedule is Monday–Friday, 9:30 a.m.–6:30 p.m. local time, including a meal break. Actual hours depend on your contract, team, client, and local law. See Section 3.1.

Q: How many annual leave days do I get?

A: The sample uses 18 days only as a placeholder. Your actual entitlement is set by the approved local policy, employment category, contract, and applicable law. Check the HR system or contact HR. See Section 4.

Q: Can I take sick leave without advance notice?

A: For illness or emergencies, notify your manager as soon as reasonably possible and complete the HR-system entry when able. Documentation rules depend on the approved policy and law. See Section 4.1.

Q: Can I book a flight before manager approval?

A: No. Obtain written approval before booking business travel. The approval should cover purpose, dates, destination, estimated cost, and cost center. See Section 5.1.

Q: Which flight class can I book?

A: The illustrative rule is economy class by default. Any exception must be approved under the actual company travel policy. See Section 5.2.

Q: Can I claim taxi bills during a business trip?

A: Reasonable business-related local transport may be reimbursable if permitted by policy. Use an approved or safe provider, keep the receipt, and record the business purpose. See Section 5.2.

Q: Are meals reimbursed during travel?

A: They may be reimbursed under the company's actual meal or per-diem rules. Check applicable limits and exclusions; avoid duplicate claims. See Section 5.4.

Q: How long do I have to submit expenses?

A: The sample suggests 30 days, but the actual policy deadline must be confirmed. Submit itemized receipts, business purpose, approvals, and cost-center details. See Section 6.1.

Q: What if I lose an expense receipt?

A: Provide an explanation and alternative evidence only if the actual policy permits it. Never create or alter a receipt. Ask Finance how to proceed. See Section 6.4.

Q: When will reimbursement reach my account?

A: Payment follows the published reimbursement cycle after approval. This sample does not specify a guaranteed date; contact Finance for the current schedule. See Section 6.3.

Q: Does the company provide health insurance?

A: Eligibility and coverage depend on the actual benefits plan and employment category. Review the plan document or contact the benefits team before assuming a service is covered. See Section 8.1.

Q: Can I bring my family member to a company event?

A: It depends on the event invitation and approved event policy. Do not assume guest expenses are covered. Confirm with the event organizer. See Sections 6.2 and 8.5.

Q: Is smart casual clothing acceptable?

A: The sample assumes smart casual attire is generally acceptable, subject to safety and client-specific requirements. Follow the dress guidance communicated for your office or role. See Section 8.4.

Q: Can I use ChatGPT or Gemini with company documents?

A: Only use AI tools approved for the data classification and task. Do not upload confidential, personal, client, or regulated data to an unapproved service. Verify outputs against approved sources. See Section 10.4.

Q: I clicked a suspicious link. What should I do?

A: Report it immediately through the designated IT/security channel. Do not enter more credentials or attempt an unauthorized investigation. See Section 10.5.

Q: How do I report harassment?

A: Contact HR, the designated ethics channel, or another authorized contact. If your usual contact is involved, use an alternative channel. Retaliation for good-faith reporting is prohibited. See Section 9.2 and Section 13.

Q: Can I work from another country for a few weeks?

A: Do not do so without advance written approval. Cross-border work can raise tax, immigration, client, legal, and security issues. See Section 3.3 and Section 5.6.

Q: What is my notice period?

A: Your notice period is stated in your employment agreement and may be affected by applicable law or an approved exception. Ask HR to confirm your final working date. See Section 14.2.

Q: When will I receive my final settlement?

A: The timeline depends on the applicable process, contract, and law. HR/Payroll should confirm the expected steps and timing. This sample does not guarantee a date. See Section 14.4.

Q: Are interview travel expenses reimbursed?

A: Only if the recruiter or hiring team explicitly approved them in writing before the expense. Retain itemized receipts and follow the provided instructions. See Section 2.2.

Q: Can I negotiate salary after receiving an offer?

A: You may discuss compensation with the recruiter before accepting. Only an authorized written offer confirms terms. See Sections 2.4 and 7.1.

Q: Can the company reimburse a certification course?

A: Possibly, if it is eligible under the actual learning policy and approved before enrollment. Confirm budget, provider, exam fees, and completion requirements first. See Section 12.2.

Q: Who do I contact about a payslip error?

A: Contact Payroll or HR through the verified channel and provide the relevant pay period and details. Never share passwords or one-time passcodes. See Section 7.3.

Q: What if the policy doesn't answer my question?

A: The assistant should say that the handbook does not specify the answer, avoid guessing, and direct the user to the relevant policy owner such as HR, Finance, IT, Facilities, or the recruiter.

16. Policy Ownership and Change Log

Field	Demo value
Document owner	People Operations / HR (fictional)

Supporting owners	Finance, IT Security, Facilities, Talent Acquisition, Legal/Compliance
Version	1.0 — illustrative draft
Prepared date	October 2026
Review status	Not approved; demo content only
Next review	Set by the real policy owner after replacing sample content
Approval authority	Must be defined by the real organization

Policy maintenance checklist

- Replace the fictional company name and overview with accurate details.
- Replace every sample entitlement, time, limit, deadline, approval path, and contact with the approved policy.
- Add the correct country, state, office, employee category, contractor, and candidate-specific variations.
- Attach or reference authoritative source documents for leave, travel, expenses, benefits, information security, and code of conduct.
- Have HR, Finance, Legal/Compliance, IT Security, and other owners review their sections.
- Record version, owner, approval date, effective date, and next review date.
- For the RAG assistant, chunk by section, retain section titles as metadata, and instruct the model to abstain when the source does not answer the question.